2026/27

Commuting To:

The University of Birmingham



The Ultimate Guide



Who are we?

The Commuter Society is the *go-to community* for home-living students at the University of Birmingham. Our goal is to help you feel connected, confident, and fully involved in campus life, no matter where your journey starts!

Committee 2026/27

President (Supreme Leader)
Safina Akhtar-Watters



Vice-president
Sam Lees

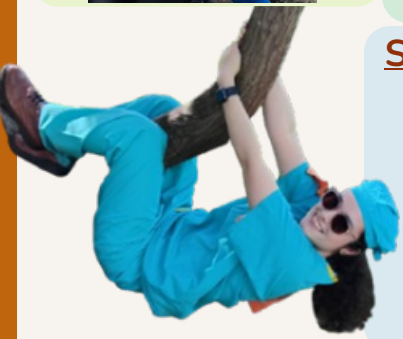


Secretary
Lily Blackwell



Treasurer
Elliot English





Social Media Officer
Dilpreet Gill



Fresher's Rep
Adam Kirkpatrick



Student banks

NatWest

- Overdraft: £2000 (yr1-2) → £3250 (yr3)
- Tastecard (4yr): discounts on deliveries, food, and attractions
- £100 bonus

Consider joining one for their bonus, then transferring to another for its bonus!

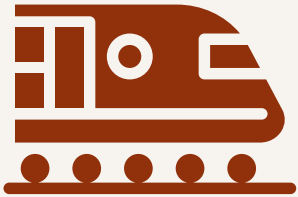


nationwide

- Overdraft: £1000 (yr1) → £2000 (yr2) → £3000 (yr3)
- £10 monthly JustEat vouchers for 12 months (£120 total)
- £100 bonus

Santander

- Overdraft: £1500 (yr1-3) → £1800 (yr4)
- 4yr 16-25 Railcard (worth £115) - 33% off eligible train journeys
- Chance to win cash up to (£20 guarantee, 1 will win £100,000)





LLOYDS

- Overdraft: £1500 (yr1-3) → £2000 (yr4-5)
- £20 monthly Deliveroo vouchers for 6 months
- £100 bonus
- Chance to win a year's tuition fees

Your guide to:



The essentials:

- Platforms: 1-12
- To UoB: Cross-City Line → usually Platforms 11/12
- Peak Times: ~7-9am, ~4-6pm

Accessibility + safety

- Lifts and tactile paving at every platform
- Staff in uniforms can assist if needed
- Keep bags zipped and stay behind the yellow line

Some Food + Coffee Spots (New Street/Grand Central)

- Pret
- Greggs
- Starbucks
- M&S Food
- Wasabi
- Five Guys



Navigation

- Use the Red Zone to reach all platforms quickly.
- At the end of each platform, use the underpass walkway to switch platforms fast.
- Platforms can change last minute- check Trainline or on the screens!

The bus network

City Centre



X20 / X21 / X22

- Catch from: University Station / North Gate
- Goes to: City Centre → New Street → Moor Street
- Wait time: <10 mins

61 / 63

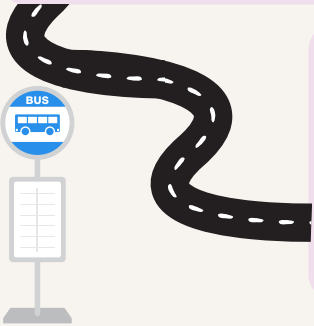
- Catch from: South Gate
- Goes to: City Centre → New Street → Moor Street
- Wait time: <10 mins

West Midlands Bus

Local Connections

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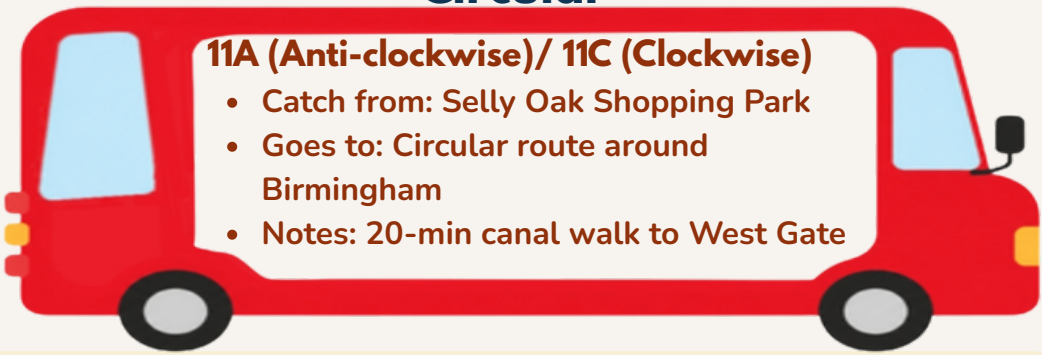
- Catch from: QE Hospital / Dawlish Road
- Goes to: Kings Heath → Shirley → Solihull
- Note: QE is a short walk from West Gate



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- Catch from: Behind University Station
- Goes to: Harborne → Bearwood Interchange → onward connections (Stourbridge, Wolverhampton, City Centre via Broad St.)
- Wait time: Every 20 mins

Circular



11A (Anti-clockwise)/ 11C (Clockwise)

- Catch from: Selly Oak Shopping Park
- Goes to: Circular route around Birmingham
- Notes: 20-min canal walk to West Gate

The X20, X21, X22, 61, and 63 are good alternatives when trains are delayed or not running through University Station!

Food and Drink on Campus

*Non-exhaustive lists

(NB: business hours may change outside of term time)

Café's

- Café 1902: Business School → Mon-Fri: 8am - 4pm
- Muirhead Tower → Mon-Fri: 8am - 6pm
- Campus Express: Murray Learning Centre → Mon-Fri: 8am - 4.30pm
- Costa Coffee: Sports and Fitness → Mon-Fri: 7am - 7pm, Sat-Sun: 8am - 6pm

Shops

- Co-op: University Centre → Mon-Fri: 7am - 10pm, Sat-Sun: 9am - 5pm
- Nisa Local: Guild of Students → Mon-Fri: 7am - 10pm, Sat: 9am - 9pm

Restaurants

- The Bratby: Staff House → Mon-Tue: 11.30am - 7pm, Wed: 11.30am - 8pm, Thu-Fri: 11.30am - 9pm
- Cuore: Green Heart → Mon-Fri: 10am - 4pm

University Centre

- Cantina (Mexican) → Mon-Fri: 10am - 4.30pm
- Kimiko (Japanese) → Mon-Fri: 10am - 7pm
- Campus infusion → Mon-Fri: 10am - 3.30pm
- Metro (Salad, toasties, jacket potato) → Mon-Fri: 8am - 4.30pm

Commuter President's pick:

Wetherspoon @ Joe's: Guild of Students: Mon- Tue: 8am - midnight, Wed: 8am - 10pm, Thu: 8am - midnight, Fri-Sat: 8am - 1am, Sun: 8am - midnight

For the list of all outlets visit: https://www.birmingham.ac.uk/about/our-campus/services-facilities/food-fellows/outlets

University Building Opening Times

(some of the main areas for study etc.)

- Teaching and Learning → Mon-Fri: 8am - 10pm
- Murray Learning Centre → Mon-Fri: *7am - 10pm; Sat-Sun: 9am - 7pm

Main Library → 24/7;
Out of semester → Mon-Fri: 8am-8pm





Aston Webb → Mon-Fri: 8am-8pm

- Sports and Fitness → Mon-Fri: 6am - 10.30pm, Weekends: 7am - 8pm.
- Collaborative Teaching Laboratory → Mon-Fri: 8.30am - 7pm

*(Some buildings require you to scan your ID before 8am)

More information at:
https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/opening-hours.aspx

Additional Resources

Core Student Resources

- MyUoB App:
https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/myuob/MyUoB.aspx
- Canvas:
https://canvas.bham.ac.uk

Academic Resources

- Library Services:
https://www.birmingham.ac.uk/libraries
- Academic Skills Centre:
https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/as/skills/index.aspx
- Resource Lists (Reading Lists) :
https://bham.rl.talis.com/index.html

Support and Wellbeing

- Wellbeing:
https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/colleges/coss/your-student-wellbeing.aspx
- Disability Support:
https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/your-wellbeing/disability/sds-applications.aspx
- Emergency & Safety:
https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/community-safety-and-security/index.aspx

Thank You!

Thanks for being part of this community!

We've put this guide together to make things a little easier for the students who come after us, and we hope it helps you find your way around campus with a bit more confidence and a bit less stress!

If you need any additional support contact Safina (President) at:

sxa2156@student.bham.ac.uk,

From the Commuter Society Committee 2026/27